

Regular expressions are patterns used to match character combinations in strings. In JavaScript

Syntax

/pattern/modifier(s);

Brackets

Brackets are used to find a range of characters:

Expression	Description
[abc]	Find any character between the brackets
[^abc]	Find any character NOT between the brackets
[0-9]	Find any character between the brackets (any digit)
[^0-9]	Find any character NOT between the brackets (any non-digit)
(x y)	Find any of the alternatives specified

Metacharacters

Metacharacters are characters with a special meaning:

Metacharacter	Description
.	Find a single character, except newline or line terminator
\w	Find a word character
\W	Find a non-word character
\d	Find a digit
\D	Find a non-digit character
\s	Find a whitespace character
\S	Find a non-whitespace character
\b	Find a match at the beginning/end of a word, beginning like this: <code>\bHI</code> , end like this: <code>HI\b</code>
\B	Find a match, but not at the beginning/end of a word

<u>\0</u>	Find a NULL character
<u>\n</u>	Find a new line character
<u>\f</u>	Find a form feed character
<u>\r</u>	Find a carriage return character
<u>\t</u>	Find a tab character
<u>\v</u>	Find a vertical tab character
<u>\xxx</u>	Find the character specified by an octal number xxx
<u>\xdd</u>	Find the character specified by a hexadecimal number dd
<u>\udddd</u>	Find the Unicode character specified by a hexadecimal number dddd

RegExp Object Methods

Method	Description
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[compile\(\)](#)

Deprecated in version 1.5. Compiles a regular expression

[exec\(\)](#)

Tests for a match in a string. Returns the first match

[test\(\)](#)

Tests for a match in a string. Returns true or false

[toString\(\)](#)

Returns the string value of the regular expression

#Example

Regular expression to match standard 10 digit phone number

regular expression for a standard US type phone number that supports the following formats

```
###-###-####  
(###) ###-####  
### ### ####  
###.###.####
```

Answer

```
^(\\+\\d{1,2}\\s)?(\\d{3}\\s)?[\\s-]\\d{3}[\\s-]\\d{4}$
```

Matches the following

```
123-456-7890  
(123) 456-7890  
123 456 7890  
123.456.7890  
+91 (123) 456-7890
```

If you do not want a match on non-US numbers use

`^\(0|1\s)?\((?d{3})?\[s.-]d{3}\[s.-]d{4}$`

Online testing

<https://regex101.com/>

<https://www.regextester.com/>

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